

HEAR

1. Passage anchor

> “Even now, I can still **hear** her voice in the back of my mind” whenever I feel self-doubt creeping in.”

Passage meaning

hear = experience or mentally recall a voice or sound, even when it is not physically being produced at that moment

彷彿聽見；在腦海中想起（聲音）

Here, the speaker is not literally hearing Mrs. Chan speaking nearby. Her words are remembered so vividly that the speaker can mentally “hear” her voice.

Practice

1. Whenever I feel nervous, I can still **hear** my teacher’s advice in my head.

每當我感到緊張時，我仍會在腦海裡**彷彿聽見**老師的忠告。

2. Years later, she could still **hear** her father’s voice in her mind.

多年後，她仍能在腦海中**想起父親的聲音**。

Core meanings of HEAR

2. hear — perceive sound with your ears

= become aware of a sound through your ears

聽見；聽到

This is the central literal meaning.

Examples

1. I can **hear** music upstairs.

我可以**聽到**樓上的音樂。

2. Did you **hear** that noise?

你有**聽到**那個聲音嗎？

Key idea

hear often describes perception that happens naturally.

You do not necessarily make a deliberate effort.

3. hear someone / something

= perceive the sound made by a person or thing

聽見某人 / 某物的聲音

Examples

1. I could **hear the children laughing** outside.

我可以**聽見孩子們在外面笑**。

2. She **heard footsteps** behind her.

她**聽見身後的腳步聲**。

4. hear someone do something

= hear the whole action or event

聽見某人做某事

Examples

1. I **heard him close the door**.

我**聽見他把門關上**。

2. We **heard someone shout** outside.

我們**聽見有人在外面喊叫**。

Contrast

hear someone do often presents the action as a complete event.

5. hear someone doing something

= hear an action while it is in progress

聽見某人正在做某事

Examples

1. I **heard her singing** in the kitchen.

我**聽見她正在廚房唱歌**。

2. He could **hear people talking** in the next room.

他可以**聽見隔壁房間有人正在說話**。

Useful distinction

* **I heard him sing.**

我聽見他唱了 / 唱完一段。

* **I heard him singing.**

我聽見他正在唱歌。

The difference is mainly how the event is viewed, not necessarily how long you physically listened.

Ability to hear

6. can hear

= be able to perceive a sound

聽得到；能聽見

Examples

1. Can you **hear me**?

你**聽得到我嗎**？

2. I can barely **hear the television** from here.

我從這裡幾乎**聽不到電視的聲音**。

Very common in:

* phone calls

* video calls

* noisy environments

7. hear clearly / well

= perceive speech or sound successfully

聽清楚；聽得清

Examples

1. I can't **hear you clearly**.

我**聽不清楚你說話**。

2. She doesn't **hear very well** without her hearing aids.

她不戴助聽器時**聽力不太好**。

Receiving spoken information

8. hear what someone says

= receive or understand someone's spoken words

聽到；聽見某人所說的話

Examples

1. I didn't **hear what she said**.

我沒**聽到她說什麼**。

2. Did you **hear the announcement**?

你有**聽到那項公告嗎**？

9. hear someone out

= listen to everything someone wants to say before judging or responding

把某人的話聽完

Examples

1. Please **hear me out** before you decide.

在你作決定之前，請先**把我的話聽完**。

2. She agreed to **hear him out**.

她同意先**聽他把話說完**。

This is a useful phrasal verb because its meaning is not fully predictable from basic **hear**.

Learn or receive information

10. hear about something

= learn information or news concerning something

聽說；得知

Examples

1. Did you **hear about the accident**?

你有**聽說那場事故嗎**？

2. I was sorry to **hear about your problem**.

得知你的問題，我感到很遺憾。

This does not necessarily mean you physically heard someone say it aloud.

The information could have come through:

* conversation

* messages

* news

* social media

11. hear of someone / something

= know that someone or something exists because you have received information about them

聽說過；知道有.....

Examples

1. Have you ever **heard of this author**?

你有沒有**聽說過這位作者**？

2. I've never **heard of that company**.

我從來沒有**聽說過那家公司**。

Important distinction

hear of

= know of the existence of

hear about

= receive information/details about

12. hear that...

= learn or be told that something is true

聽說；得知

Examples

1. I **heard that you got a new job**.

我**聽說你找到新工作了**。

2. We **heard that the event had been cancelled**.

我們**得知活動被取消了**。

This is extremely common.

13. hear from someone

= receive a message, call, email, letter, etc. from someone

收到某人的消息；接到某人的聯絡

Examples

1. I haven't **heard from her** for weeks.

我好幾個星期都**沒有她的消息**。

2. Let me know when you **hear from the university**.

大學**聯絡你 / 有消息給你**時告訴我。

This does not specifically mean physical hearing.

14. hear back from someone

= receive a reply or response from someone

收到回覆；得到答覆

Examples

1. I'm still waiting to **hear back from the company**.

我還在等公司**回覆**。

2. Have you **heard back from** the school yet?

學校已經**回覆你**了嗎？

Very common conversational expression.

Being informed officially

15. hear something from someone

= receive information from a particular source

從某人那裡得知

Examples

1. I **heard the news from Sarah**.

我是**從 Sarah 那裡得知這個消息的**。

2. We first **heard about the change from our manager**.

我們最初是**從經理那裡得知這項變動的**。

16. hear word / hear news

= receive news or information

得到消息；聽到消息

Examples

1. We haven't **heard any news** yet.

我們還沒有**得到任何消息**。

2. As soon as I **hear anything**, I'll call you.

我一有**任何消息**就會打給你。

Listening to a case or argument

17. hear a case

= formally listen to evidence and arguments in a court or tribunal in order to decide a case

審理案件

Examples

1. The court will **hear the case** next month.

法院下個月將**審理此案**。

2. A different judge was appointed to **hear the case**.

另一名法官被指派來**審理案件**。

This is a genuinely distinct legal sense.

18. hear evidence / testimony

= formally receive and consider evidence or testimony

聽取證據 / 證詞

Examples

1. The court **heard evidence** from several witnesses.

法院**聽取了**數名證人的**證據**。

2. The committee **heard testimony** from experts.

委員會**聽取了**專家的**證詞**。

This extends from the literal act of hearing to formal consideration.

Considering someone's argument

19. hear someone

In formal contexts:

= listen to and consider a person's case, argument, or request

聽取某人的陳述；聽某人申辯

Examples

1. The panel agreed to **hear both sides**.

委員會同意**聽取雙方陳述**。

2. At least **hear what she has to say** before making a decision.

作決定之前，至少先**聽聽她怎麼說**。

Mental recollection

20. hear a voice in your head / mind

= mentally recall or imagine a person's voice

****在腦海中彷彿聽見某人的聲音****

This is the passage sense.

Examples

1. I can still ****hear my grandmother's voice in my head****.

我現在仍能在腦海裡****彷彿聽見祖母的聲音****。

2. Whenever I hesitate, I ****hear my coach telling me not to give up****.

每當我猶豫時，我腦海裡就會****想起教練叫我不放棄的聲音****。

This may describe ordinary memory or imagination; the context determines the interpretation.

Response and acknowledgment

21. I hear you

= I understand what you are saying or how you feel

****我懂你的意思；我理解你的感受****

Examples

1. ****I hear you****, but we still need to make a decision.

****我明白你的意思****，但我們還是需要作決定。

2. ****I hear you.**** That sounds really frustrating.

****我理解你的感受。那聽起來真的很令人沮喪。**

This is figurative: understanding rather than merely auditory perception.

22. hear someone loud and clear

A. literally hear very clearly

****聽得非常清楚****

B. understand someone's message completely

完全明白；非常清楚你的意思

Examples

1. "Can you hear me?" "***Loud and clear.**"
「你聽得到嗎？」 「**聽得非常清楚。**」

2. Your message has been **heard loud and clear**.
你的意思我們已經**完全明白了**。

Common fixed expressions

23. hear, hear!

= an expression showing strong agreement with what someone has just said
說得好！贊成！

Examples

1. "We need more support for teachers." "***Hear, hear!**"
「我們需要給老師更多支持。」 「**說得好！**」

2. Several people shouted, "***Hear, hear!**"
好幾個人喊道：「**說得好！**」

Especially associated with British English and formal/public discussion.

24. you heard me

= what I said is exactly what I mean, often emphatic
你沒聽錯；我就是這個意思

Examples

1. **You heard me**—I'm leaving tomorrow.
你沒聽錯，我明天就要走。

2. "Did you say ten?" "***You heard me.**"
「你說十個？」 「**你沒聽錯。**」

Can sound forceful depending on tone.

25. have you heard?

= used to introduce news or gossip

你聽說了嗎？

Examples

1. **Have you heard?** Maya is moving abroad.

你聽說了嗎？ Maya 要搬到國外了。

2. **Have you heard the news?**

你聽到那個消息了嗎？

26. not hear the end of it

= continue to be reminded, criticized, or teased about something for a long time

被一直念個不停；這件事會被說很久

Examples

1. If I forget her birthday, I'll **never hear the end of it**.

如果我忘了她生日，她一定會**一直念我很久**。

2. He lost the bet and **didn't hear the end of it for weeks**.

他打賭輸了之後，好幾週都**一直被拿這件事開玩笑**。

Highly idiomatic.

27. hear yourself think

= be able to think because the environment is quiet enough

安靜到能思考；聽得見自己的思緒

Usually negative:

I can't hear myself think.

Examples

1. Turn the music down—I can't **hear myself think**.
把音樂關小一點，我吵得**根本沒辦法思考**。
2. It was so noisy that I could barely **hear myself think**.
那裡太吵了，我幾乎**無法集中思考**。

Religious / literary extension

28. hear a prayer / plea

= listen to and respond favorably to a prayer or plea

垂聽；聽取

Examples

1. They prayed that their request would be **heard**.
他們祈禱自己的請求能被**垂聽**。
2. The ruler refused to **hear their plea**.
統治者拒絕**聽取他們的請求**。

More literary/formal in many contexts.

Related forms

29. hearing — ability to hear

= the physical sense by which sounds are perceived

聽力

Examples

1. His **hearing** has become weaker with age.
他的**聽力**隨著年齡增長而下降。
2. The test checks your **hearing**.
這項測試會檢查你的**聽力**。

30. hearing — formal meeting or legal proceeding

= an official occasion at which evidence, arguments, or views are heard

****聽證會；審理程序****

Examples

1. The court scheduled a ****hearing**** for Monday.

法院安排星期一進行****聽證 / 審理****。

2. Residents spoke at the public ****hearing****.

居民在公開****聽證會****上發言。

This derives from the legal/formal ****hear**** sense.

31. hearing aid

= a device that helps a person hear better

****助聽器****

Examples

1. He wears a ****hearing aid****.

他戴著****助聽器****。

2. Modern ****hearing aids**** can be very small.

現代****助聽器****可以非常小。

32. unheard

A. not heard

****沒被聽見的****

B. not previously known or experienced, especially in ****unheard of****

****聞所未聞的；前所未有的****

Examples

1. Her request went ****unheard****.

她的請求****沒有人理會 / 沒有被聽見****。

2. Such prices were once **unheard of**.

這樣的價格過去簡直**聞所未聞**。

33. unheard-of

= extremely unusual or previously unknown

聞所未聞的；罕見的

Examples

1. That level of growth was almost **unheard-of**.

那種成長幅度幾乎是**前所未聞的**。

2. Working remotely every day was once **unheard-of** in the company.

每天遠距工作以前在公司裡是**難以想像的**。

Key contrasts

34. hear vs listen

This is the most important distinction.

hear

= perceive sound, often without deliberate effort

聽見

listen

= deliberately pay attention to sound

聽；傾聽

Compare:

> I can **hear music**.

> 我**聽得到音樂**。

> I'm **listening to music**.

> 我正在**聽音樂**。

You can **hear** something without **listening** to it.

35. hear vs listen to someone

hear someone

= perceive what the person says

聽見某人說話

listen to someone

= deliberately pay attention to them

聽某人說；傾聽某人

Compare:

> I **heard him**, but I wasn't really **listening to him**.

> 我**聽見他在說話**，但其實沒有真正**專心聽他說**。

36. hear about vs hear of

hear about

= receive information or details concerning something

聽說某件事；得知相關消息

> I **heard about the accident**.

> 我**聽說了那場事故**。

hear of

= know that someone or something exists

聽說過

> Have you **heard of that author**?

> 你**聽說過那位作家嗎？**

37. hear from vs hear about

hear from someone

= receive communication from that person

****收到某人的消息****

****hear about someone****

= receive information concerning that person

****聽到關於某人的消息****

Compare:

> I ****heard from James**** yesterday.

> James 昨天****聯絡我了****。

> I ****heard about James**** yesterday.

> 我昨天****聽說了 James 的一些消息****。

These are very different.

38. hear vs overhear

****hear****

= perceive sound generally

****overhear****

= hear something accidentally that was not intended for you

****無意中聽到；偷聽到****

Examples

1. I ****heard them talking**** outside.

我聽到他們在外面說話。

2. I ****overheard their conversation**** on the train.

我在火車上****無意中聽到了他們的談話****。

39. hear vs sound

****hear****

describes the receiver's perception.

****sound****

describes the impression produced by the sound.

Compare:

> I can **hear** her voice.
> 我可以**聽見**她的聲音。

> Her voice **sounds tired**.
> 她的聲音**聽起來很疲倦**。

Grammar patterns

40. hear + object

- * hear a noise
- * hear music
- * hear someone
- * hear the news

Example

I **heard a strange noise**.
我**聽到一個奇怪的聲音**。

41. hear + object + base verb

> I heard her **close** the door.

Often presents the action as a whole.

我聽見她把門關上。

42. hear + object + -ing

> I heard her **closing** the door.

Focuses on the action as it was happening.

我聽見她正在關門。

43. hear + that-clause

> I heard **that you were leaving**.

= receive information that...

聽說.....

44. hear about / of / from

The preposition changes the meaning:

* **hear about X** → 得知關於X的消息

* **hear of X** → 聽說過X

* **hear from X** → 收到X的消息 / 聯絡

These should be learned as separate high-value patterns.

Meaning map

The core idea of **hear** is:

receive sound through the ears

From this develop several branches:

Physical perception

hear music

→ **聽見**

Spoken message

hear what someone says

→ **聽到**

Information

hear that... / hear about...

→ **聽說 ; 得知**

Contact

hear from someone

→ **收到消息**

Formal consideration

hear a case

→ **審理；聽取**

Understanding

I hear you

→ **我理解你**

Mental recollection

hear someone's voice in your mind

→ **在腦海中彷彿聽見**

The common thread is:

****something reaches you as a message or sound and becomes mentally available to you.****

Passage recap

> “Even now, I can still ****hear her voice in the back of my mind**** whenever I feel self-doubt creeping in.”

Here:

****hear**** = ****mentally recall or vividly imagine the sound of someone's voice****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****仍能在腦海中聽見她的聲音****

* ****彷彿仍聽得到她的聲音****

* naturally: ****每當自我懷疑浮現時，我腦海裡仍會響起她的聲音****

MCQ-ready meaning

****hear**** in the passage

= ****mentally recall or experience a remembered voice****

****在腦海中彷彿聽見；想起某人的聲音****

The physical sense **聽見聲音** supplies the metaphor, but the actual passage refers to **memory rather than a present external sound**.